Combined instructor key

Keep separate from the student handout. Updated October 20, 2026. Round numbers match the revised eight-round handout.

Round	Topic	Source	AI impostor	A words	B words
1	College and personal growth	Class submission	**B**	239	222
2	Rhetoric and philosophy	MIT student coursework	**A**	212	228
3	Energy and environmental policy	MIT student coursework	**B**	206	219
4	Psychology	OpenStax textbook excerpt	**A**	200	181
5	Economics	OpenStax textbook excerpt	**B**	206	213
6	Biology	OpenStax textbook excerpt	**A**	209	184
7	Sociology	OpenStax textbook excerpt	**A**	214	216
8	Astronomy	OpenStax textbook excerpt	**B**	216	210

Revision and AI generation

The advisor question has been omitted at the instructor's request because its original submission lacked an authorship key. The remaining rounds are renumbered: the retained class submission comes first, followed by two MIT student examples, then five textbook examples.

Every AI answer in this edition was newly composed in response to the activity question. The replacements were not paraphrased from the human passages or matched to their wording, examples, length, or paragraph structure. Shared details specified by a question, such as Selena's ticket price, necessarily remain. All AI answers were written by this assistant; they are not additional student submissions. The first-person college response is a generated sample, not a person's reported experience.

This revision was produced in the existing conversation, where the source passages had already been visible; it was not a separate blinded model experiment. The external-source questions also remain the earlier prompts adapted to fit the excerpts. These limits distinguish independent composition from a claim of complete experimental isolation.

All retained human/source answers and all retained questions are unchanged. Existing A/B positions are preserved. Earlier packets and the archived nine-round edition contain superseded AI answers; use this combined handout and key together.

Original class submission

Round 1 preserves the original Word submission's question and human Answer A. The submitted private key explicitly identifies A as the student's own work. Answer B has now been replaced with a newly generated response; it is no longer the AI text supplied by the student. Student names are omitted from the judging handout.

MIT student examples

Rounds 2 and 3 contain excerpts from historical, named student coursework; their wording was checked against the original PDFs. The activity questions were adapted to fit the excerpts. Only layout and footnote callouts were normalized in the human passages. Both alternative answers were regenerated for this edition.

Round 2 - Truth and Rhetorical Effectiveness

Student author(s): Kevin Liu. **Date:** Spring 2005. **Course:** MIT 21W.747 Rhetoric.

Authorship evidence: MIT's course page identifies the student work and authors.

Original document: Download the student paper.

Original assignment context: Assignment A1 asked students to examine a debatable aspect of the relationship between rhetoric and truth. The original task was a 3-5-page essay, not the short question below. Original assignment source.

Exact excerpt location: First two body paragraphs, PDF pages 1-2, ending with "a speaker's rhetoric."

Activity question: What are a speaker's two main objectives, and why might measurable facts and moral claims affect persuasion differently? Introduce the distinction and explain how rhetorical techniques fit into it. Here, rhetoric means the use of language to communicate and persuade.

Instructor notes: This is the introduction to a longer student argument, not a complete answer to every part of the original assignment. The shorter activity question is written to fit the excerpt. The quoted phrase and four-category framework are credited by the student to James A. Herrick, The History and Theory of Rhetoric: An Introduction, 2nd ed., 2001; original footnotes 1 and 2 refer to that book.

Round 3 - Why Fusion? The Politics and Policy of Energy in the United States

Student author(s): Jessica Lynch and Laura Jacox. **Date:** May 11, 2006. **Course:** MIT 22.012 Seminar: Fusion and Plasma Physics.

Authorship evidence: MIT's course page identifies the student work and authors.

Original document: Download the student paper.

Original assignment context: The course assigned a short term paper or PowerPoint equivalent and an oral presentation on a subject discussed in class. The students chose energy policy. The activity question below is a new, narrower prompt based on their discussion of fission. Original assignment source.

Exact excerpt location: PDF page 5 (printed page 4), two complete paragraphs beginning "Fission has positive attributes" and "Nuclear power had promising beginnings."

Activity question: Discuss the environmental benefits and drawbacks of nuclear fission power, and explain how public reactions to accidents can influence support for it. Fission is the splitting of atomic nuclei to release energy. Treat this as a discussion framed in 2006, not an update on today's energy policy.

Instructor notes: This is jointly authored student work. The authors' conclusion that the drawbacks outweigh the benefits is an argumentative position, not a settled finding. Preserve it for authorship comparison rather than silently rewriting it. Their prose also contains broad claims: the no-greenhouse-gases statement concerns generation, not the full fuel and construction life cycle; environmental effects depend on plant design and operation. "Today" refers to 2006. Original footnote 9 cites S. M. Meyer, Energy and the Environment: The Story of an Addict, MIT lecture, May 2, 2005. Footnotes 10 and 11 cite J. V. Switzer, Environmental Politics: Domestic and Global Dimensions, 4th ed., 2004, pages 178-179.

Textbook examples

Rounds 4-8 contain copied OpenStax textbook excerpts, not student submissions. Books originally appeared in 2015-2020; the current web pages may include later revisions, whose complete editorial histories and precise AI contribution have not been independently audited. The answer mapping identifies the known AI-written alternative against the published textbook excerpt; it is not a forensic guarantee about every stage of the source's editorial history. Each adapted short question was AI-generated, and every AI counterpart was regenerated for this edition.

Sources and excerpt audit

Round 4 - Psychology: Correlation and causation

Source: Rose M. Spielman, William J. Jenkins, and Marilyn D. Lovett, *Psychology 2e*, OpenStax. Original book publication: April 22, 2020. Read the section.

Passage: The two opening paragraphs of section 2.3, before Correlational Research.

Editorial treatment: No wording changes; paragraph layout normalized.

Debrief: Both answers reject the causal inference and offer temperature as a possible common cause. The example illustrates a plausible explanation; it is not a claim that temperature accounts for every crime trend.

Round 5 - Economics: Sunk costs

Source: Steven A. Greenlaw and David Shapiro, *Principles of Economics 2e*, OpenStax. Original book publication: October 11, 2017. Read the section.

Passage: Sunk Costs subsection, the paragraph beginning Consider the case of Selena and the following paragraph beginning For people and firms alike.

Editorial treatment: No wording changes; paragraph layout normalized.

Debrief: The relevant comparison is between future options. Leaving is reasonable under the stated expectations, but the rule does not mean that every disappointing project should automatically be abandoned.

Round 6 - Biology: Individuals and evolution

Source: Mary Ann Clark, Matthew Douglas, and Jung Choi, *Biology 2e*, OpenStax. Original book publication: March 28, 2018. Read the section.

Passage: Misconceptions of Evolution, Individuals Evolve subsection, complete body text.

Editorial treatment: No wording changes; paragraph layout normalized.

Debrief: The unit changing across generations is the population. The AI answer adds a useful qualification: a change in a measured average alone does not establish a genetic change.

Round 7 - Sociology: Written and unwritten rules

Source: Heather Griffiths and Nathan Keirns, *Introduction to Sociology 2e*, OpenStax. Original book publication: April 24, 2015. Read the section.

Passage: Norms subsection: paragraph beginning Formal norms, followed by the paragraphs beginning There are plenty and But although.

Editorial treatment: Three intact paragraphs selected. Intervening examples about theft and drunk driving omitted. No sentences rewritten.

Debrief: The key distinction is how expectations are established and communicated. Both written rules and informal expectations can have consequences; informal does not mean unimportant.

Round 8 - Astronomy: Why seasons differ between hemispheres

Source: Andrew Fraknoi, David Morrison, and Sidney C. Wolff, *Astronomy*, OpenStax. Original book publication: October 13, 2016. Read the section.

Passage: Paragraph beginning Many people have believed, then the opening paragraph of The Seasons and Sunshine starting with Note that our axis.

Editorial treatment: The sentence introducing Figure 4.5 is omitted because the figure is not reproduced. Other wording unchanged.

Debrief: Opposite seasons are strong evidence against distance as the main explanation. The source's "about 3%" is an approximate end-to-end orbital-distance variation; distance does affect solar energy received, but axial tilt dominates this seasonal pattern.

Reuse

OpenStax material is credited in each student round. This adaptation is distributed for noncommercial educational reuse under CC BY-NC-SA 4.0. Preserve credits and source links when sharing. See OpenStax licensing and customization.

Scoring and provenance

The handout contains eight pairs: one retained class submission, two MIT student excerpts, and five textbook excerpts. The seven external examples do not earn a classmate author bonus. Keep them as practice unless you explicitly adapt scoring. If all eight rounds count, the student whose submission appears in Round 1 can judge seven rounds; everyone without an answer in this packet can judge all eight. Do not automatically use N = 8 in the original participant-based formula. Because Round 1's AI counterpart was replaced by the instructor, omit or revise its original author-bonus scoring as well.

All sixteen answers meet the 150-word minimum. Word counts exclude headings, questions, and credits. Shared round-level credits remain on the handout without identifying which answer is the source excerpt. Ask judges not to follow the links until after voting.